

Attendance, Hours and Time Off Policy

Company: Northwind Digital (fictional demo company)

1. Standard working hours

The standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday. Core working hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time. Flexible start and end times are permitted provided the employee is available during core hours.

2. Working days and weekends

Saturday and Sunday are non-working days. Some customer-facing teams operate a rotating weekend roster; team members on the roster receive time off in lieu for each weekend shift worked.

3. Recording time

Employees do not clock in or out. Time worked is recorded through the timesheet in the HR portal, which must be submitted every two weeks. Submitting a timesheet late more than three times in a quarter is treated as a policy violation.

4. Late arrival

Arriving after 10:00 is recorded as a late arrival. More than 3 late arrivals in a calendar month triggers a conversation with the manager. Frequent lateness may result in formal disciplinary action.

5. Absence without notice

An employee who does not attend work and does not notify their manager before the scheduled start time is recorded as an unauthorised absence. Three unauthorised absences in a rolling 12-month period are treated as gross misconduct and may result in dismissal.

6. Working during sickness

Employees who are unwell should not work, even remotely. If an employee reports working while on sick leave, People Operations may request a medical certificate to confirm fitness to work.

7. Overtime

Overtime is not paid. Time worked beyond 40 hours in a week is taken back as time off in lieu, which must be taken within the following calendar month. Approval for overtime is required in advance from the direct manager.

8. Part-time and flexible schedules

Part-time schedules are agreed per employee and normally run at 80% or 50% of full time. Flexible schedules covering an early shift (07:00 start) are available to designated teams.

9. Travel and commuting

Employees who travel for work record travel time as working time where reasonably possible. Commuting time is not recorded as working time.

10. Breaches of this policy

Breaches are handled through the disciplinary process described in the Code of Conduct. Where an absence is caused by an emergency, the employee is expected to notify their manager as soon as reasonably practicable.

Attendance records are reviewed by People Operations every month.